Before solving a problem understand it

Albert Einstein once said," If I were given one hour to save the planet, I would spend 59 minutes defining the problem and one minute resolving it." Now, that might seem extreme, but it does show us just how important it is to define the problems before trying to solve them. A lot of times, teams jump right into data analysis before realizing a few months later that they are either solving the wrong problem or they don't have the right data. In this video, we will learn how to develop a structured approach to defining the problem domain. This is important because if you define the problem clearly from the start, it'll be easier to solve, which saves a lot of time, money, and resources. In the data world, we call this first piece the problem domain: the specific area of analysis that encompasses every activity affecting or affected by the problem. Before we can do anything else, we need to understand the problem domain and all of its parts and relationships so that we can discover the whole story. Actually calling it the first piece makes me think of a jigsaw puzzle. Say you have a puzzle. Let's think of that puzzle as our problem domain. You have all 500 pieces but you lost the box. So you don't know what image the puzzle will reveal. Will it be an animal? A waterfall? A bowl of oranges? Whatever it is, it's going to be tough trying to put it together without an image you can refer to. Even the greatest puzzler in the galaxy would need a new process and lots of time to complete that puzzle. Data analysts face the same kinds of challenges too. You might remember that data analysts aren't always given the complete picture at the start of a project. A big part of their job is to develop a structured approach and use critical thinking to find the best solution. That starts with understanding the problem domain. This is where structured thinking comes into play. To successfully solve a problem as a data analyst, you need to train your brain to think structurally. That's exactly what you'll learn coming up. See you there.